

ONE-DAY MASTERCLASS

CURTIN EXECUTIVE EDUCATION • DR MICHAEL BORCK

01

# THE HUMAN EDGE

*Using & delivering AI with judgement.*

“If the AI is good at running your work, it's good at running everyone else's. Generic competence is the baseline — not the advantage.

SO WHERE DOES YOUR EDGE LIVE?

TODAY

03

# One idea. Two scales.

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## MORNING

The judgement, at the level of your own work: the trust tool, RTCF, the two-pass demo.

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## AFTERNOON

The same judgement, lifted to delivery: the five differences, human-in-the-loop, the go/no-go.

The trust tool – taught once, reused at project scale

PART ONE

# THE AVERAGE,

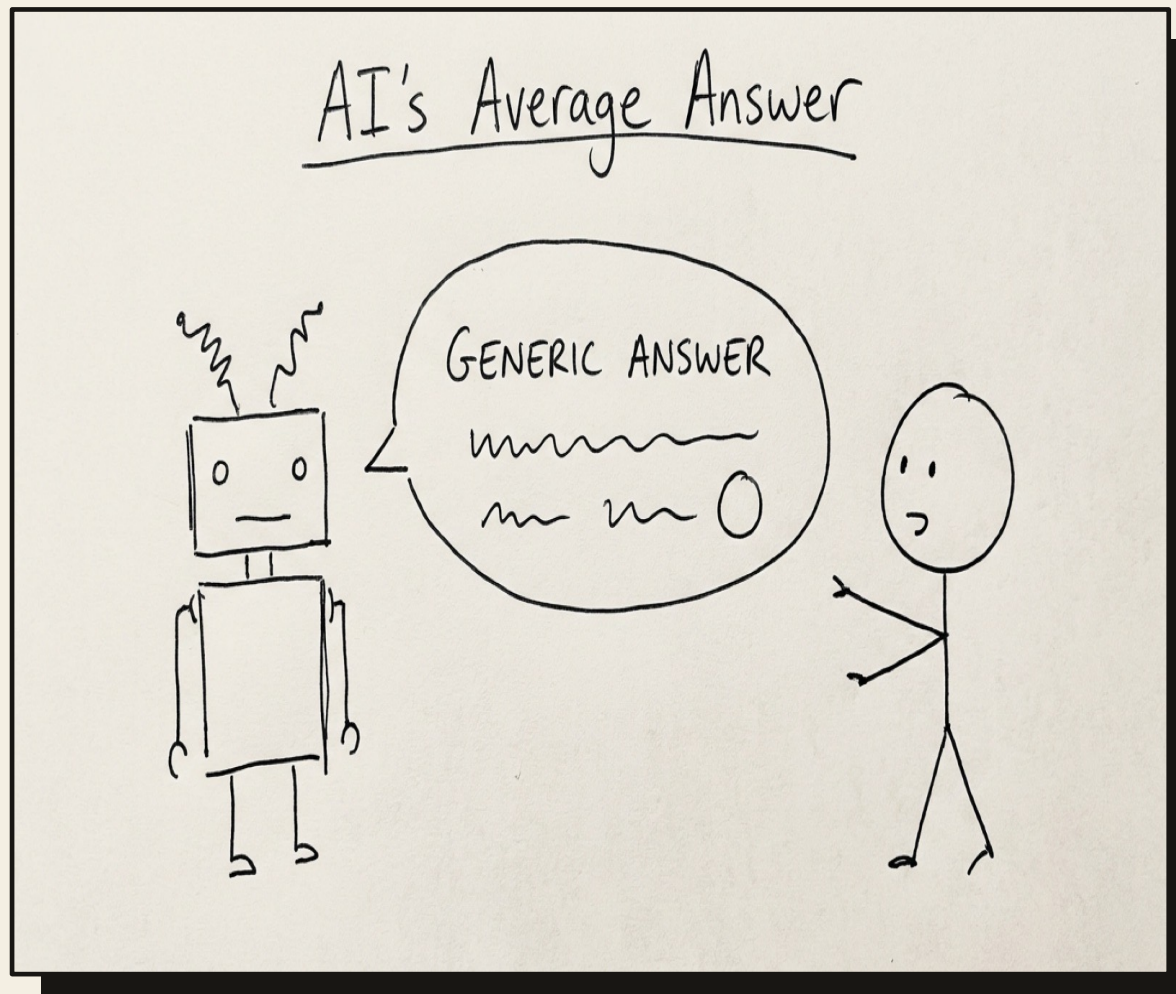
# THE TOOL,

*Personal fluency – the argument that lasts after the next model ships.*

WHAT AI ACTUALLY IS

# It predicts the next word.

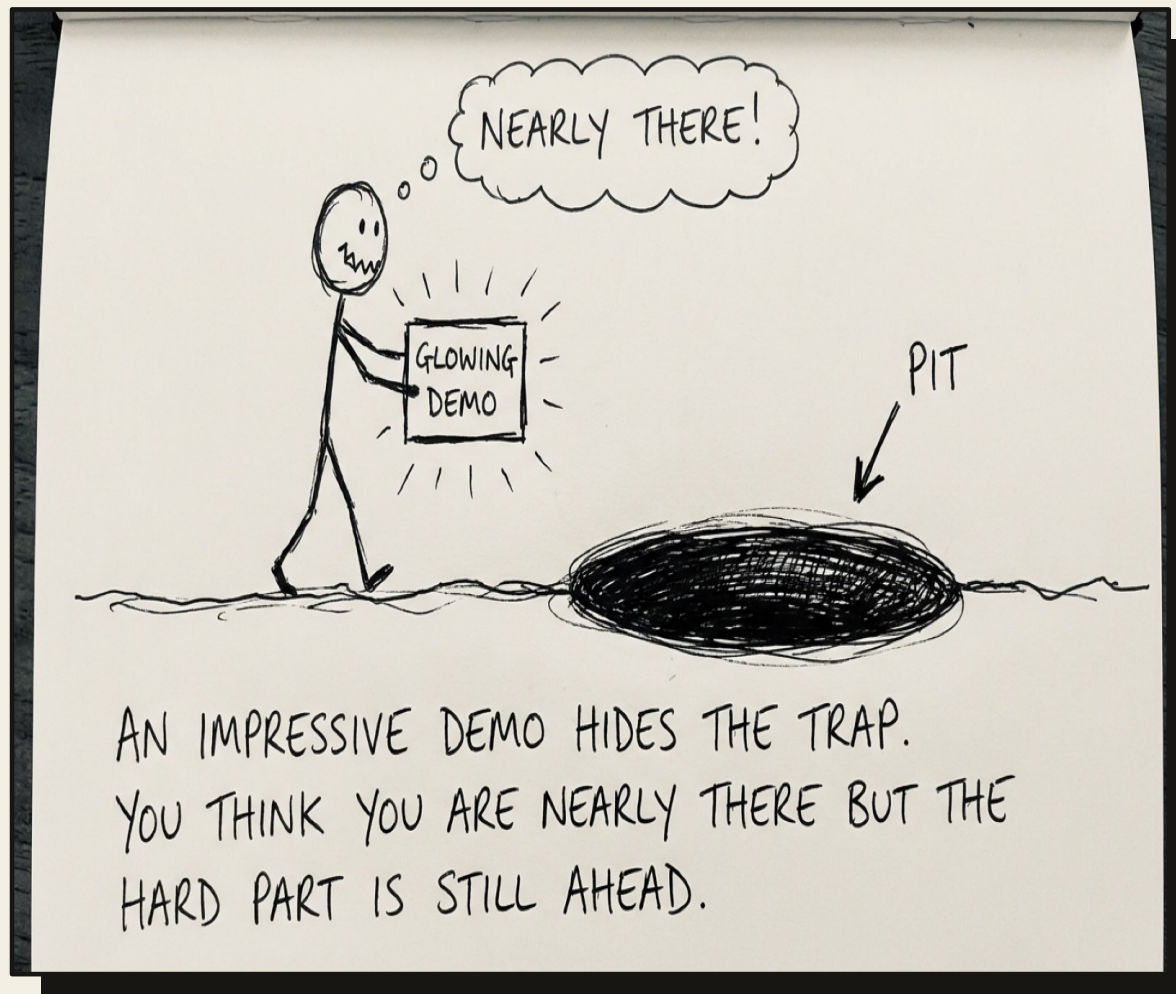
Autocomplete, scaled up. Trained on billions of pages, it learned what tends to follow what. The result looks like understanding. It's pattern-matching.



THE ONE MENTAL MODEL TO KEEP

## A convincing average.

Fluent, plausible, usually about-right. But "about right" and "exactly right" are not the same — and knowing which you need is the whole game.



ONCE YOU SEE IT AS AN AVERAGING MACHINE

07

# Brilliant here. Quietly wrong there.

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## BRILLIANT

Drafting, summarising, formatting, brainstorming, explaining, finding patterns — where "the plausible version" is the answer.

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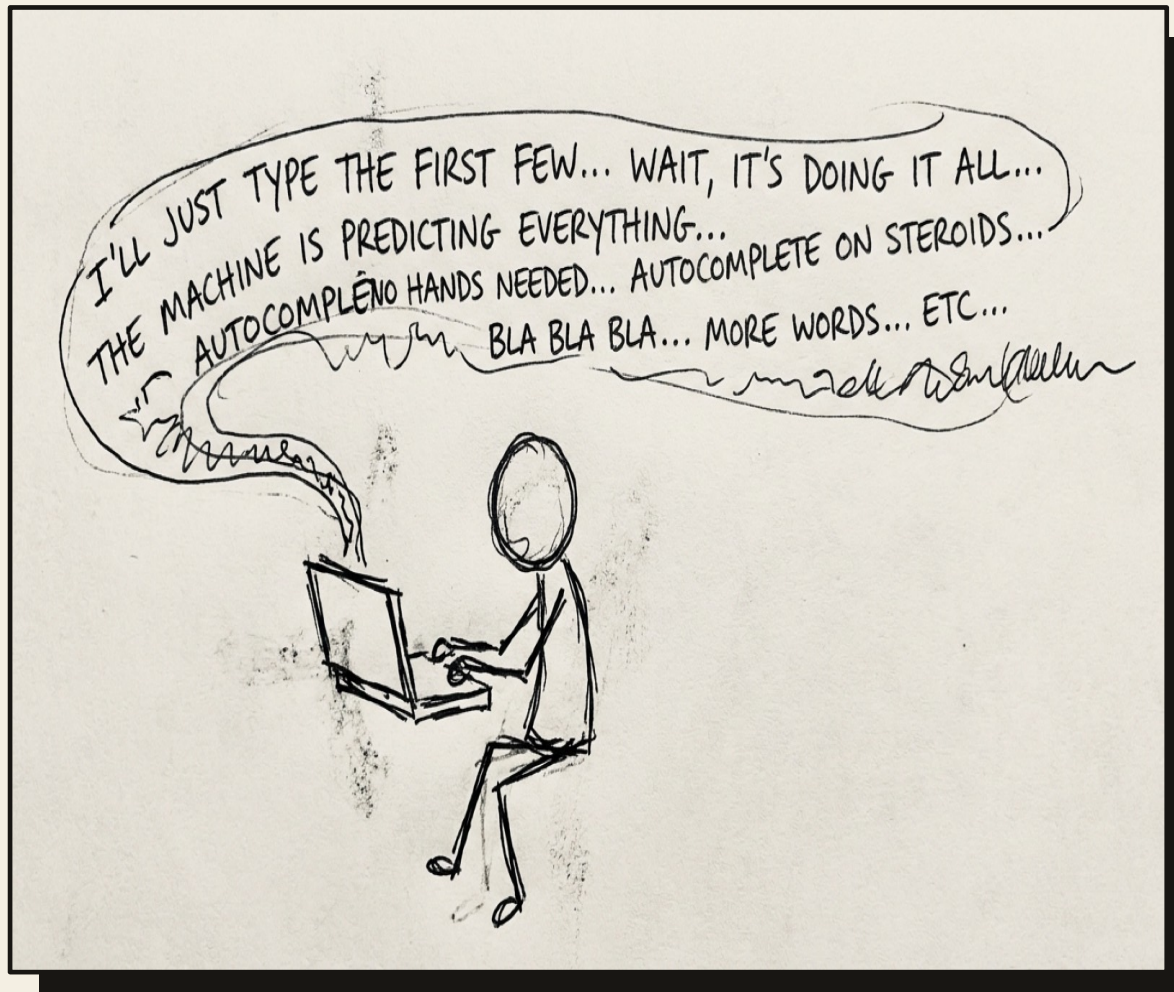
## UNRELIABLE

Precise facts, figures, citations, multi-step logic, your context, ethics — where there's one right answer it can't verify.

NOT A BUG — A PROPERTY

# Confident. Wrong. Same polish.

It never says "I don't know." The fluent-but-wrong answer looks identical to the fluent-and-right one. Nothing in the tone warns you.





# The trust tool.

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## AVERAGE → LEAN IN

Low stakes, "about right" is fine. Let AI run; you glance.

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## PRECISE → HUMAN IN THE LOOP

High stakes, one right answer. A person owns the decision.

# Average or precise? Small or large?

Drafting an internal email. Average is fine, stakes small — lean in.

Board-paper figures. Precision required, stakes large — a human owns every number.

Summarising fifty complaints for themes. Lean in for the themes, then skim for the one complaint the AI smoothed away.

# RTCF — two halves.

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## R · T · F SCAFFOLDING

Weaker & self-hosted models need it spelled out. A frontier model infers it from clear writing.

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## C ALWAYS MATTERS

Context is the one thing only you supply. No model manufactures your edge.

# Unusable. Then sendable.

Without: "Write an email about the project delay."

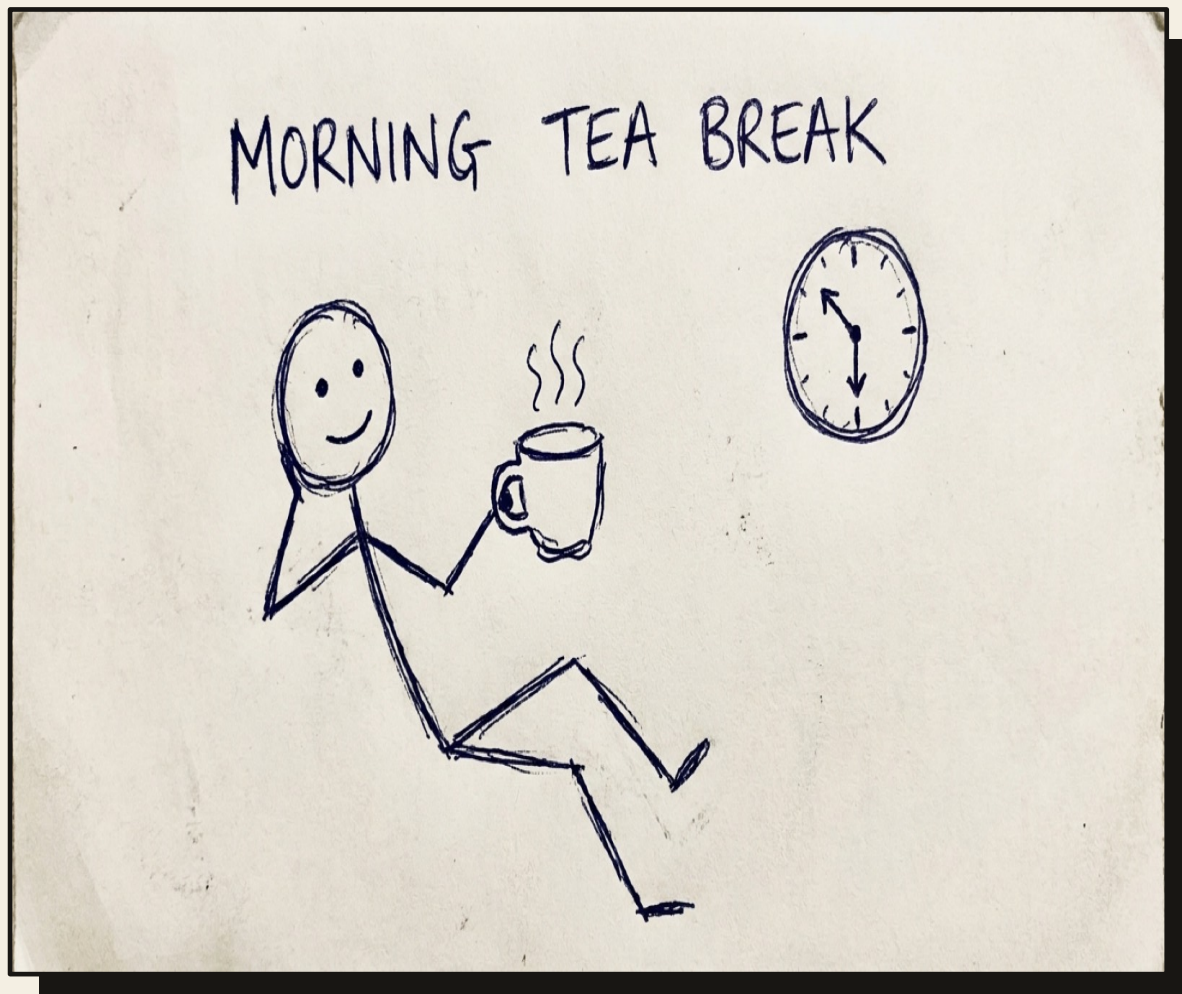
With RTCF: a senior PM, professional & empathetic, writes a client email explaining a 2-week delay (vendor integration; client values transparency; new date March 15), under 200 words — acknowledge → explain → new date → recommit.

Context is where your edge enters.

THE MONEY MOMENT — LIVE

# Add your edge. It gets a soul.

Pass 1: a naive prompt → slick, correct, identical for everyone. Pass 2: layer in what only you hold. Watch the output turn yours.



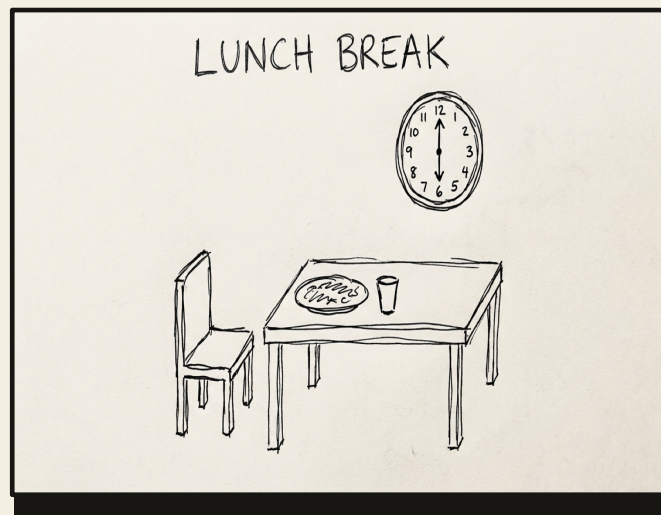
# Redesign one workflow.

Pick a task you own. List its steps. Judge each with the trust tool — where does AI genuinely help, where must your judgement stay in charge? Redesign so AI handles the average and you keep the high-stakes parts. You leave with something to trial next week.

# A mental model, a grid, a method.

AI produces a convincing average. The trust tool tells you when to lean in. RTCF directs it well — and Context is the part that survives any model. One question for the afternoon: if this is how I trust AI on a single task, how do I trust it across a whole project?

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**10:30**  
*Morning tea*

BACK AT 11:00



PART TWO

# WHY AI

# DELIVERY IS

*how the delivery team has one funded initiative — without the predictable failures.*

“I've delivered projects before. What's actually different about an AI project?”

THEY DON'T FAIL MORE OFTEN. THEY FAIL DIFFERENTLY — IN PLACES YOU DIDN'T SEE COMING.

# They fail *differently*.

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**01**

"Done" can't be specified.

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**02**

The demo is a trap.

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**03**

The data is the uncertainty.

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**04**

Verification is the product.

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**05**

Generic competence is the baseline.

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So you design the human in.

DIFFERENCE 01

# "Done" won't hold still.

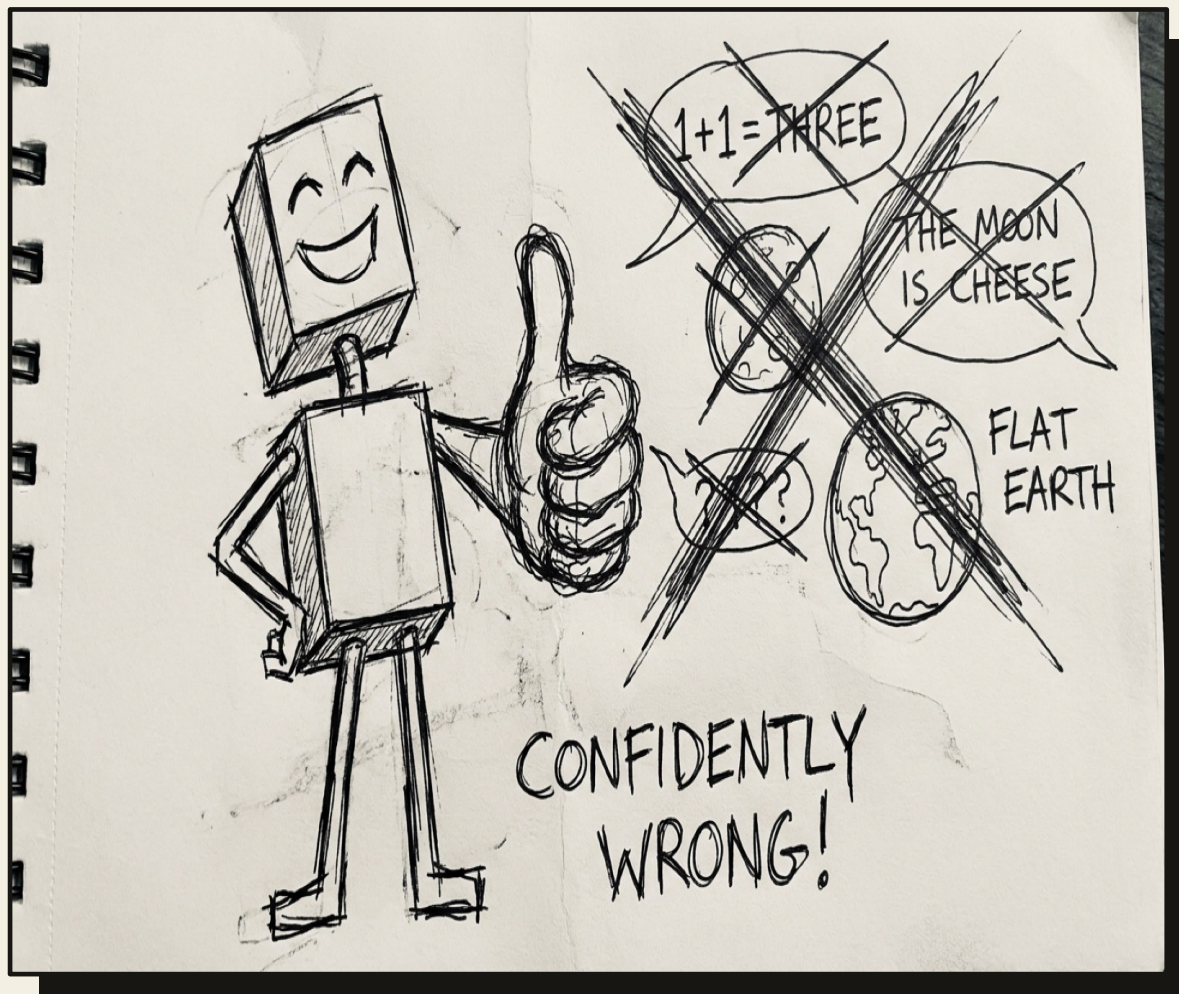
Ask twice, get two answers. There's no single correct output — only a spread. Stop chasing a fixed spec; decide what "good enough" looks like for this use.



DIFFERENCE 02

# The demo is a trap.

It shows the happy path. The messy real-world cases are where it falls over. Treat the demo as the start of the hard part — not the end.

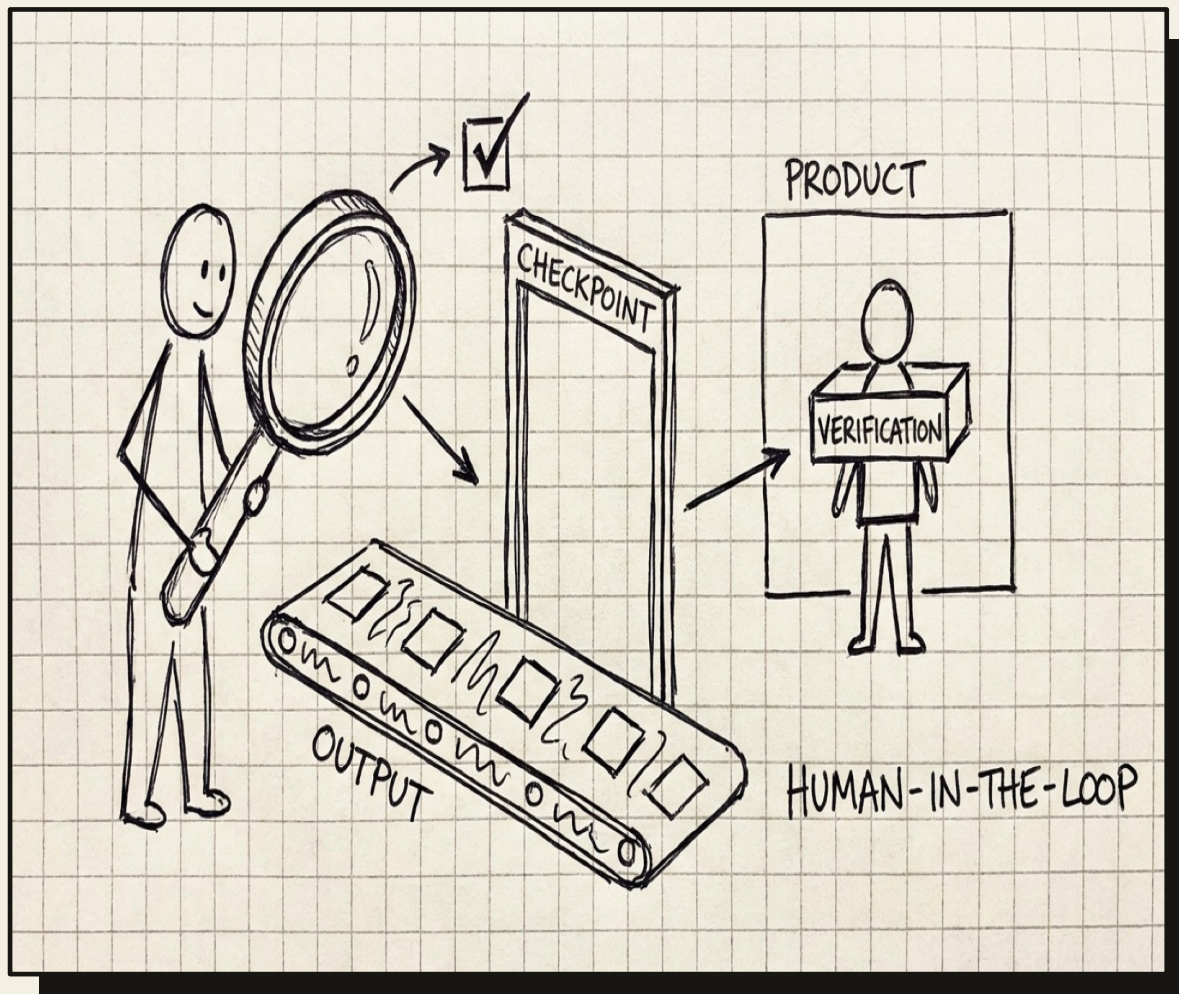




## DIFFERENCE 03

# The data is the uncertainty.

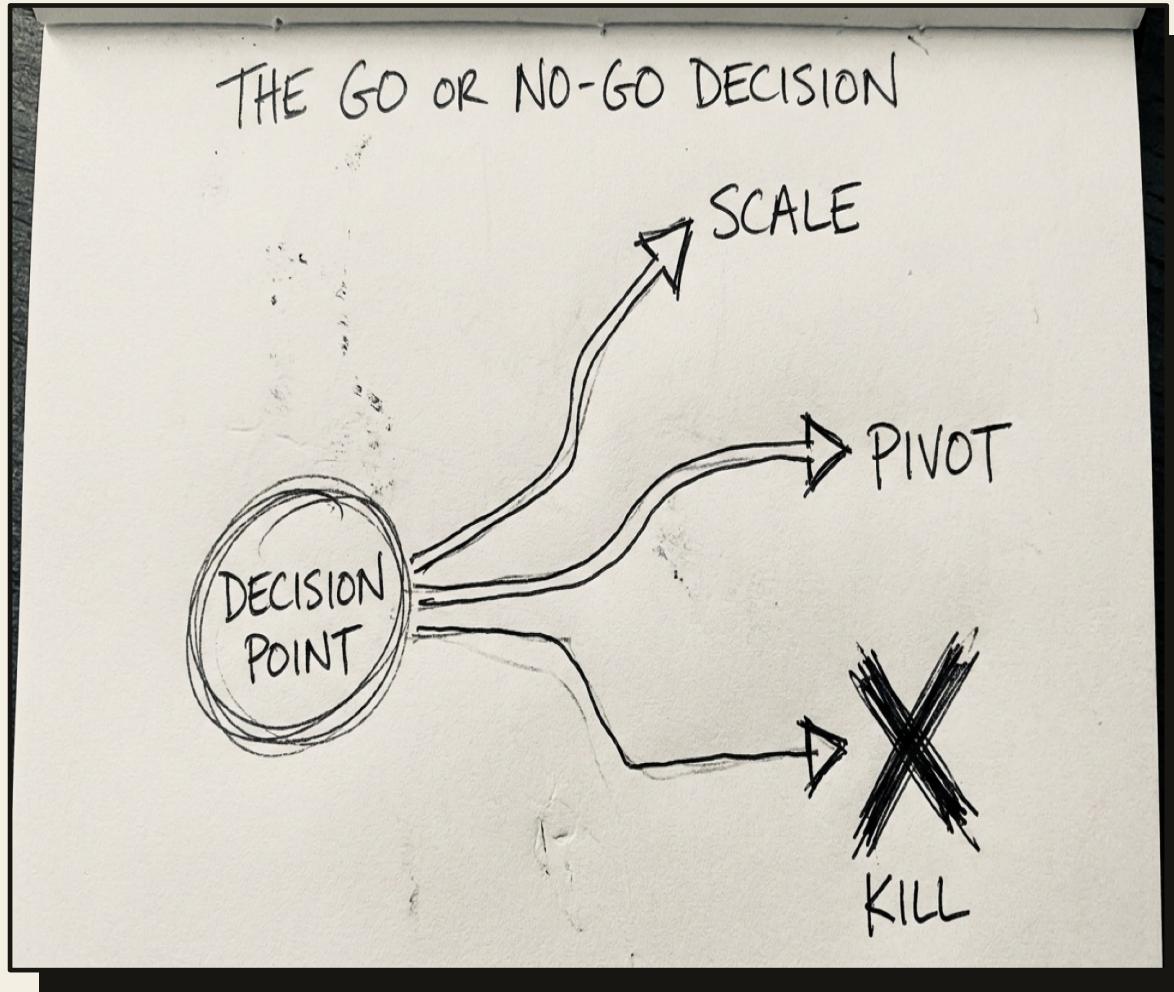
You don't order it; you discover it — its gaps, biases and surprises show up only when you work with it. Run delivery as discovery, and build the learning into the plan.



DIFFERENCE 04

# Verification is the product.

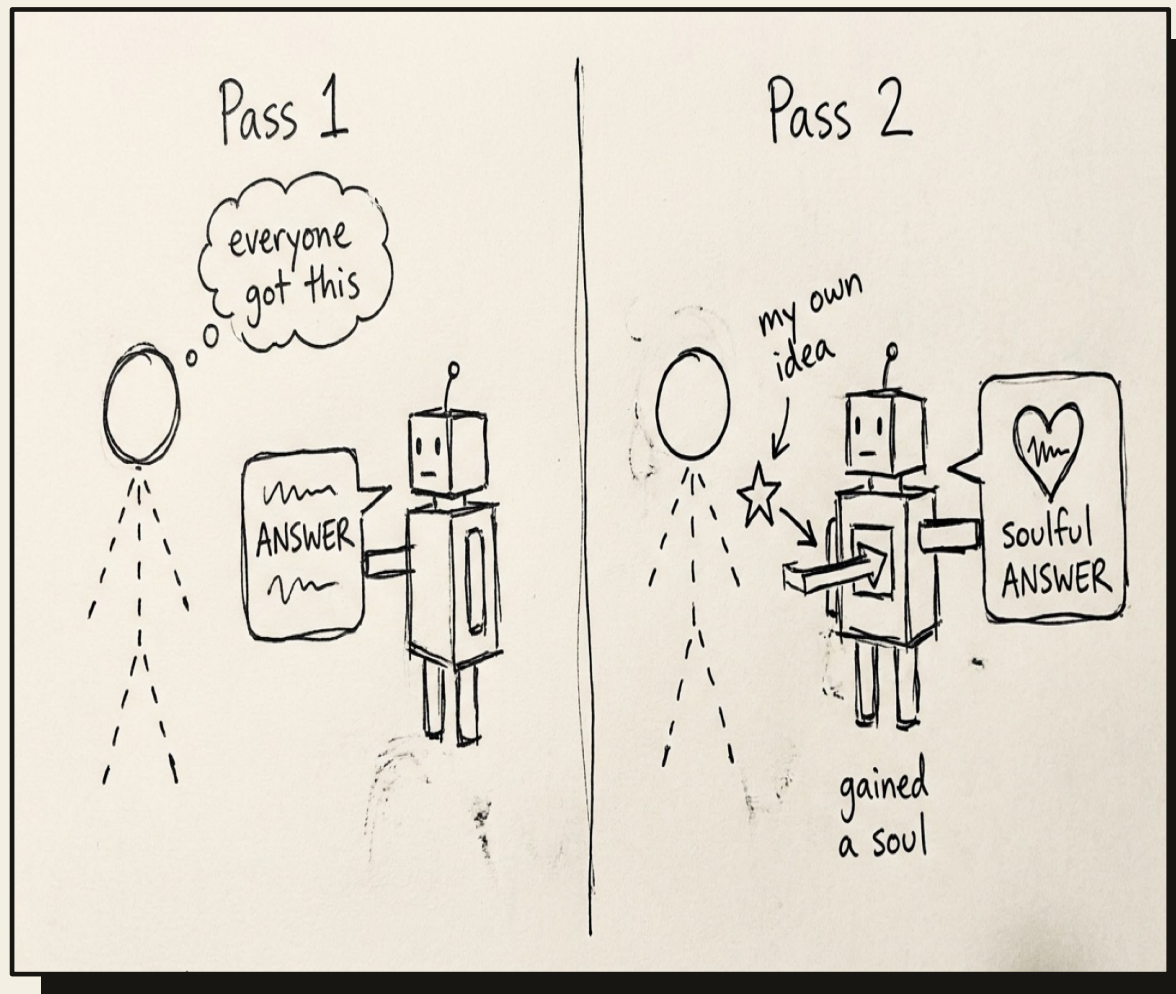
Outputs vary and can be confidently wrong. The value lives in how you check them, and where a human stays in the loop. Design the checking deliberately — make it part of what you ship.



DIFFERENCE 05

# Generic is the baseline, not the edge.

When every rival runs the same models, the model isn't your advantage — anyone can have it. Compete on the human variation a rival's identical model can't reproduce.





“AI gives you something fluent and roughly-right, fast — then asks you to decide when roughly-right is good enough, and who checks when it isn't.

A LEADERSHIP QUESTION. WHICH IS WHY IT LANDS ON YOUR DESK.

# You're the delivery lead.

The board funded one AI initiative. Ship it without the predictable failures. Carry it through three moves — scoping and stress-testing it by interviewing the RetailFlow team: live chatbots with opinions, who disagree, and won't do your job for you. access code: pilot2024

# Scope. Verify. Decide.

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01

## Scope it against reality

Interview Data & CIO. Reconcile "move fast" with "the data isn't ready." → objectives, data needs, a defined "good enough."

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02

## Stakeholders & human-in-the-loop

Interview MD, frontline, CFO. Decide where a human must stay in charge. → stakeholder plan + checkpoint design.

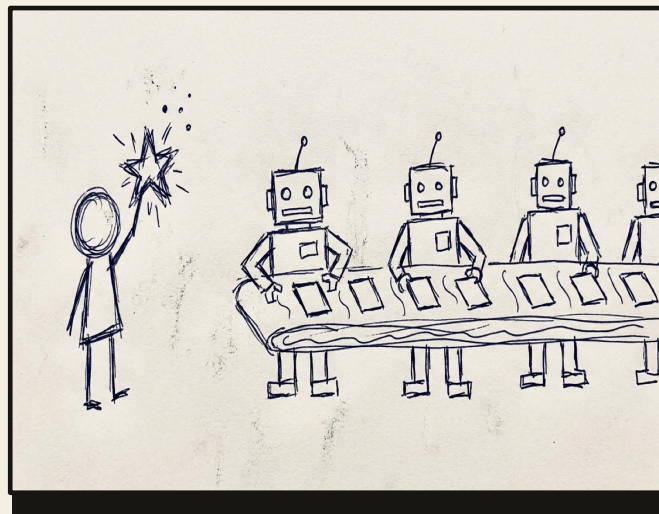
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03

## Roadmap & the go/no-go

Build the roadmap with gates and a risk register. Then make the call: Scale, Pivot, or Kill.

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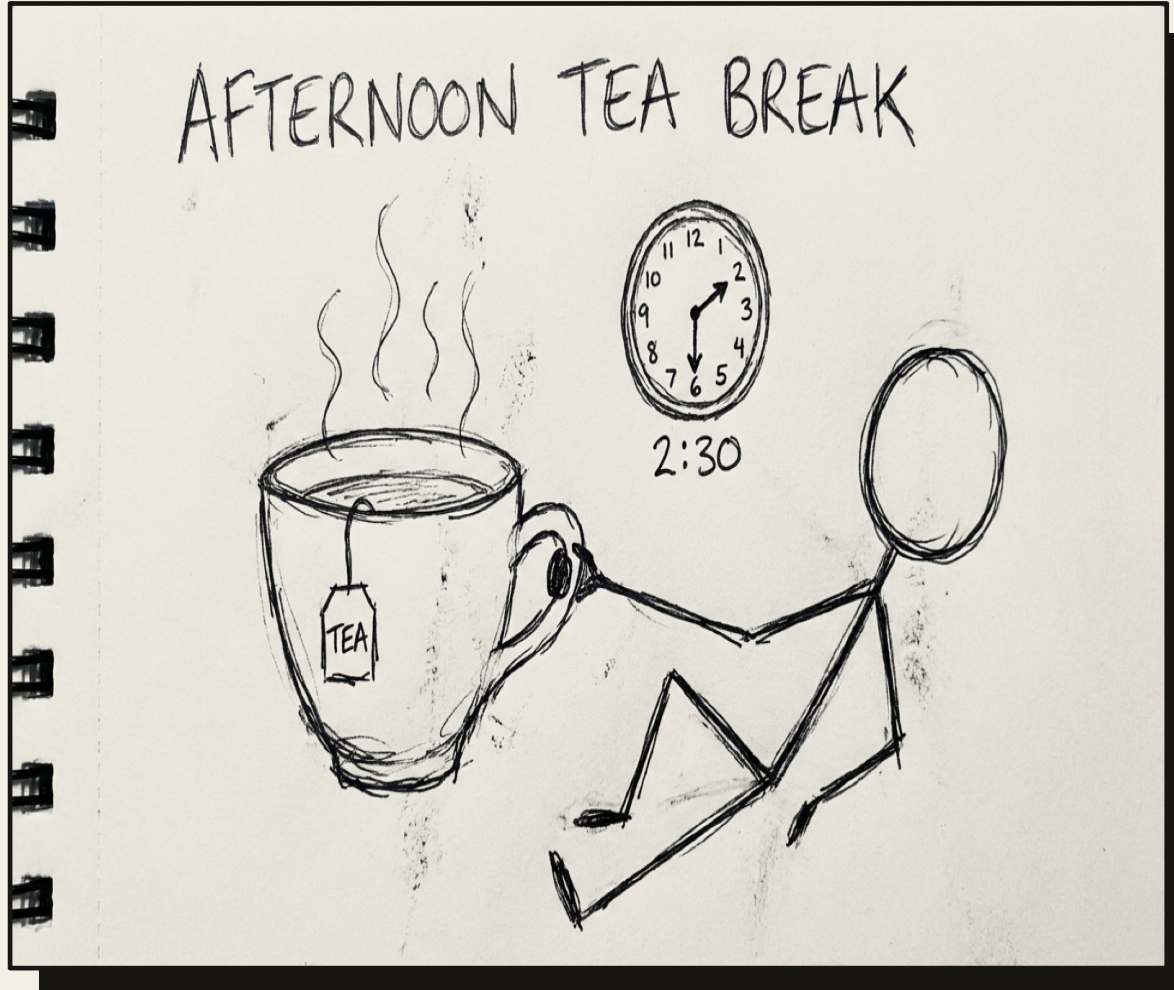
12:30

*Lunch*

BACK AT 1:15

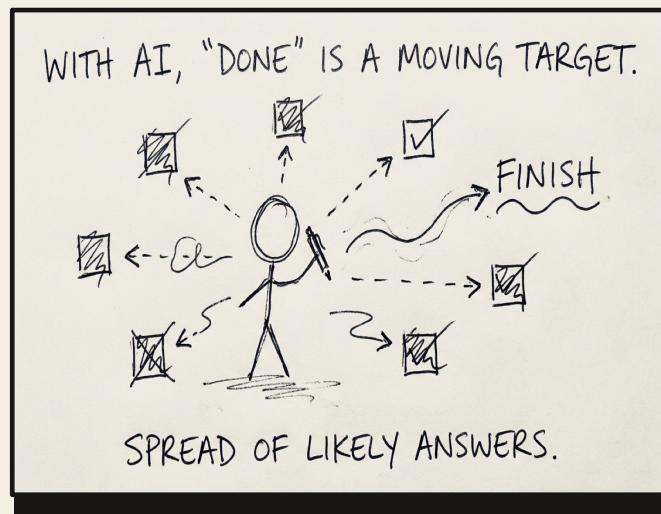
THE GO / NO-GO CALL

# Scale. Pivot. Kill.



At each gate the question isn't "is it perfect?" — it's whether the evidence justifies continuing. Killing early is success, not failure.

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**2:30**  
*Afternoon tea*

BACK AT 3:00

# A delivery design, not a theory.

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## SCOPE

Objectives, data requirements, a defined "good enough."

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## ROADMAP

Milestones and go/no-go gates.

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## CHECKPOINTS

A stakeholder plan and human-in-the-loop design.

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## RISK

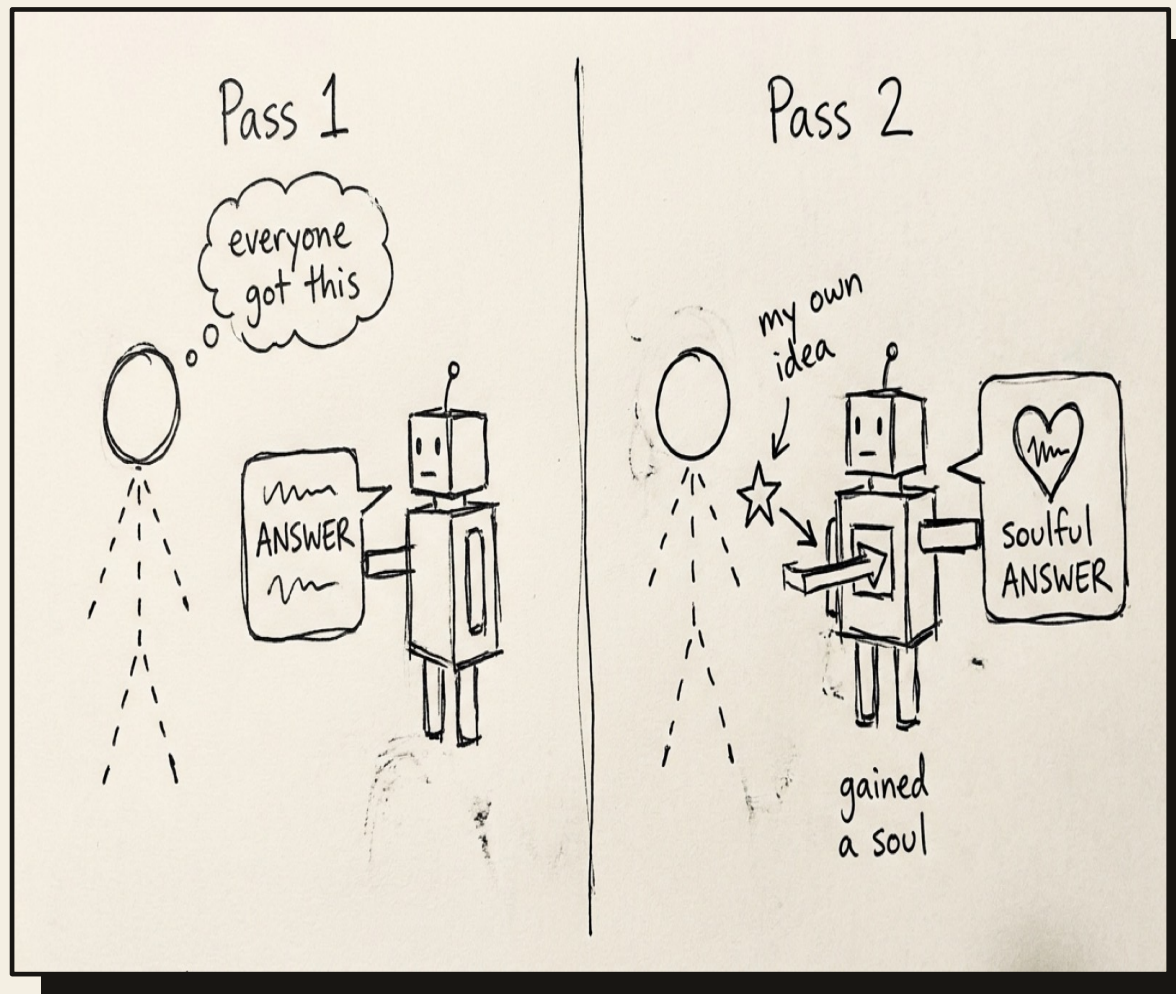
A register and a Scale / Pivot / Kill call you can defend.



BACK TO THE PROVOCATION

# The edge is the part the tool can't average.

Averages converge. Your taste, your contrarian calls, your specific customers — that's the variation a rival's identical model can't reproduce.



# Your action plan.

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## WEEK

Trial your redesigned workflow. Run one task through the trust tool first.

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## MONTH

Make RTCF a habit. Start one conversation about where a human stays in the loop.

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## QUARTER

Scope one real initiative — and defend the Scale / Pivot / Kill call.

# Tools that don't expire.

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## DECISION TOOLS

The trust tool, RTCF, the five differences, Scale / Pivot / Kill — any platform, any model.

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## A PLAN

Specific commitments for the week, month and quarter.

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## YOUR WORK

A redesigned workflow and a scoped project design you can act on.

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## GO DEEPER

[michael-borck.github.io/the-human-edge](https://michael-borck.github.io/the-human-edge) — incl. the two-page voice method.

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THE AI IS YOUR STARTING POINT, NOT YOUR FINISH LINE

**STAY THE ONE**

**HOLDING THE**

*michael-borck.github.io/the-human-edge*

**JUDGEMENT**